

NORTHFIELD & VALE RETAIL GROUP

Human Resources Policy Handbook (Excerpt)

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This policy applies to all full-time, part-time, and temporary employees of Northfield & Vale Retail Group ("the Company") across all store locations, distribution centers, and corporate offices. It establishes the Company's standards for attendance, leave, conduct, and workplace safety.

2. EMPLOYMENT CLASSIFICATION

2.1 Full-Time Employees: Scheduled to work 32 or more hours per week. Eligible for full benefits after a 90-day introductory period. 2.2 Part-Time Employees: Scheduled to work fewer than 32 hours per week. Eligible for prorated benefits after 6 months of continuous service. 2.3 Temporary/Seasonal Employees: Hired for a defined period not to exceed 6 months. Not eligible for benefits unless converted to a permanent role.

3. PAID TIME OFF (PTO)

3.1 Full-time employees accrue PTO at a rate of 1.25 days per month of service, up to a maximum of 15 days per calendar year. 3.2 PTO requests must be submitted through the WorkdayPlus portal at least 10 business days in advance for requests exceeding 3 consecutive days. 3.3 Unused PTO may be carried over up to a maximum of 5 days into the following calendar year. Any balance above this cap is forfeited on December 31. 3.4 Employees with more than 5 years of tenure accrue an additional 0.25 days per month.

4. SICK LEAVE

4.1 All employees accrue 1 hour of sick leave for every 30 hours worked, consistent with applicable state law. 4.2 Sick leave may be used for the employee's own illness, medical appointments, or to care for an immediate family member. 4.3 Absences of 3 or more consecutive days due to illness require a physician's note submitted to the HR Shared Services team within 5 business days of return.

5. ATTENDANCE AND PUNCTUALITY

5.1 Employees are expected to arrive at their scheduled shift start time. Arrivals more than 10 minutes after the scheduled start are recorded as a "tardy." 5.2 Three tardies within a rolling 90-day period will result in a documented verbal warning. A fourth occurrence will result in a written warning, escalating per the Progressive Discipline Policy (Section 9). 5.3 No-call/no-show absences are treated as job abandonment if not remedied within 2 business days.

6. CODE OF CONDUCT

6.1 Employees must treat coworkers, customers, and vendors with respect and courtesy at all times. 6.2 Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind is strictly prohibited and should be reported immediately to a supervisor or the confidential HR Ethics Line at 1-800-555-0199. 6.3 Use of personal mobile devices on the sales floor is limited to scheduled breaks.

7. WORKPLACE SAFETY

7.1 All employees must complete annual safety training modules via the LearnHub platform within 30 days of their hire date and annually thereafter. 7.2 Any workplace injury, regardless of severity, must be reported to a manager within 24 hours and documented via an Incident Report Form. 7.3 Personal protective equipment (PPE) is mandatory in all distribution center areas marked with safety signage.

8. REMOTE AND HYBRID WORK

8.1 Corporate office employees in eligible roles may work remotely up to 2 days per week, subject to manager approval. 8.2 Remote work arrangements are reviewed quarterly and may be revised based on business needs.

9. PROGRESSIVE DISCIPLINE

9.1 The Company follows a four-step progressive discipline process: verbal warning, written warning, final written warning, and termination. Serious violations (e.g., theft, safety violations, harassment) may result in immediate termination regardless of prior disciplinary history.

10. POLICY REVIEW

This policy is reviewed annually by the HR Policy Committee and is subject to change. Employees will be notified of material changes at least 15 days before they take effect.

For questions regarding this policy, contact HR Shared Services at hr-support@nvretail.example or extension 4400.